

MS Excel Basics

Study Hub — Beginner Notes

1. What is Microsoft Excel?

Microsoft Excel is a spreadsheet program used to enter, organize, calculate, analyze, and present data. It is commonly used for budgets, marksheets, reports, lists, and data analysis.

2. Basic Excel Terms

Term	Meaning
Workbook	An Excel file containing one or more worksheets.
Worksheet	A spreadsheet page made of rows and columns.
Cell	The intersection of a row and a column, such as A1.
Row	A horizontal line of cells, identified by numbers.
Column	A vertical line of cells, identified by letters.
Formula	An expression used to calculate a result, usually starting with =.

3. Common Excel Functions

SUM: Adds numbers. Example: =SUM(A1:A10)

AVERAGE: Finds the average. Example: =AVERAGE(B2:B10)

MAX: Returns the largest value. Example: =MAX(C2:C20)

MIN: Returns the smallest value. Example: =MIN(C2:C20)

COUNT: Counts cells containing numbers. Example: =COUNT(A1:A20)

IF: Returns one result when a condition is true and another when it is false. Example:
=IF(B2>=50,"Pass","Fail")

4. Useful Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + C	Copy
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + X	Cut
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + F	Find
Ctrl + A	Select all
F2	Edit the active cell

5. Practice Task

Create a small student marksheet with columns for Name, English, Maths, Computer, Total, Average, and Result. Use SUM, AVERAGE, and IF to calculate the results.

Tip: Save your workbook regularly and use clear headings for your data.